



IONICS
IONICS, INCORPORATED

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June 10, 1999

Federal Maritime Commission
Attn: Mr. Harold J. Creel
800 N. Capital N.W.

Dear Mr. Creel:

I am writing in reference to the current by COSCO North America to be able to match their competitors 24-hour rate filling as opposed to the 30-day restriction,

There have been several occasions where COSCO North America could not be considered for shipments based on this time delay. In order to provide the service to meet our customer's needs it is of great importance that our carrier is able to respond quickly. This is very important in today's market place where price & delivery are critical.

I feel that COSCO North America is a responsible carrier who should be able to respond to the marketplace in the same time period that their competition does. We have used COSCO on several occasions and they have performed well.

Thank you for your consideration on this very important matter.

Sincerely,

Steven C. Farris
Traffic Manager

